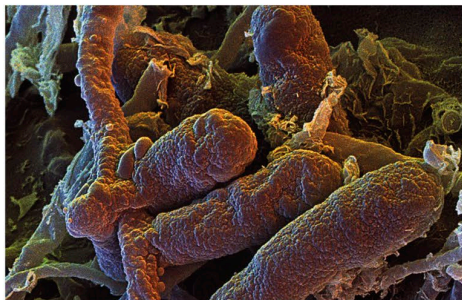
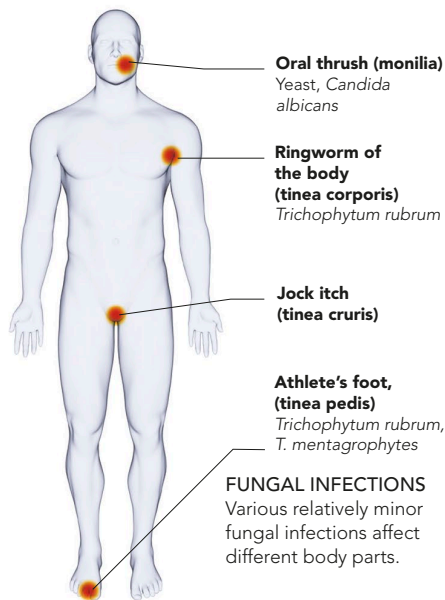


FUNGI

Disease-causing fungi fall into two main groups: filamentous fungi and single-celled yeasts. Some types – for example, thrush – cause fairly harmless diseases of the skin, hair, nails, or mucous membranes. Others, such as histoplasmosis, result in potentially fatal infections of vital organs such as the lungs. Some infections may be linked to specific occupations such as farming, while others – ringworm (dermatophytosis), for example – are more likely to affect people with damaged immune systems, such as those with HIV–AIDS.

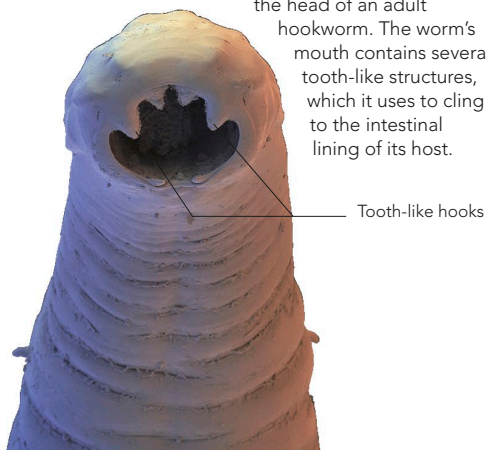


CAUSE OF ATHLETE'S FOOT

Seen here are microscopic threads of the fungus *Epidermophyton floccosum*, one cause of the white, itchy skin of athlete's foot.

HOOKWORM

This microscope image shows the head of an adult hookworm. The worm's mouth contains several tooth-like structures, which it uses to cling to the intestinal lining of its host.



PARASITIC WORMS

Humans, like most other animals, can be infested with parasitic worms that derive all their nutrients from their hosts. At least 20 types of worm-like animals may live in the body as parasites. Most spend at least part of their life cycle in the intestines. A few are members of the annelids, a group of segmented worms that includes common earthworms. Several are roundworms, or nematodes – for example, the hookworm *Ancylostoma duodenale*, which is 1 cm ($\frac{4}{5}$ in) long and lives in the gut. Another worm-like group is the flatworms; it includes the tapeworms, such as *Taenia*, which live in the gut and may reach 9m (30ft) in length, and flukes, such as *Schistosoma*, which causes schistosomiasis, or snail fever.